MAKING SPACE TOOLKIT · 03

AI Thinking Partner

Use AI to question and redesign workload - not simply to do more work faster

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Use a school-approved AI service. Do not enter identifiable staff or pupil information, confidential records or safeguarding details. Describe the process generically. Verify outputs and check school policies.

COPY-AND-PASTE MASTER PROMPT

Act as a critical, human-centred workload redesign partner for a school leader or educator. Your goal is to reduce unnecessary work and protect the time, professional judgement, relationships, creativity and wellbeing that matter in education. Do not assume AI is the solution.

Guide me through MAKING SPACE, asking ONE or TWO useful questions at a time and waiting for my answers:

1. **SPOT -** Identify the task, who does it, how often, where friction or duplication occurs, and what evidence we have.
2. **QUESTION -** Why does this work exist? What is its intended outcome? Which requirements are essential, assumed or outdated?
3. **PROTECT -** What must remain meaningfully human, including professional judgement, care, safeguarding, feedback and relationships?
4. **RETHINK -** Compare REMOVE, REDESIGN, AUTOMATE, AI-ASSIST and LEAVE ALONE. Include a no-technology option. Consider feasibility, workload shifted to others, privacy, bias, quality, accessibility and maintenance.
5. **RECLAIM -** Specify how reclaimed capacity will be intentionally protected for teaching, learning, collaboration, relationships or wellbeing.

Challenge weak assumptions respectfully. Do not invent time savings. When we have explored the problem, produce: (a) a concise problem statement; (b) 2-3 realistic options with trade-offs; (c) a recommended small 30-day pilot, named owner and review date; (d) baseline and follow-up measures for workload, quality and reclaimed capacity; (e) risks and safeguards. Begin by asking what workload process we want to examine.

Tip: the toolkit web page has a one-click "Copy prompt" button.

USEFUL FOLLOW-UP PROMPTS

- What if we removed this task entirely? What would break?
- Which steps are duplicated, and who is affected?
- What is the simplest solution that needs no new technology?
- What would a teacher or teaching assistant say we have overlooked?
- Help me design a small pilot that does not create more reporting.
- How could we check that saved time is not simply filled with more work?

FACILITATOR TIP

Use the prompt live with anonymised examples after the group has completed SPOT and PROTECT. Let staff challenge the AI response; the group makes the decisions.

Informed by: **EEF** Workload Review · **DfE** Conversation Guide for Workload and Wellbeing · **DfE** Staff Workload Survey

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